

Week 4 / Thursday

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Markup Languages

A markup language, which is **distinct from "writing code,"** can be defined as:

a text-encoding system which specifies the structure and formatting of a document and potentially the relationships among its parts. Markup can control the display of a document or enrich its content to facilitate automated processing.

– Wikipedia

WYSIWYG vs. Plain Text Editors

WYSIWYG ("What You See is What You Get") editors display formatted text while you type, whereas plain text editors omit formatting, often so that the "plain" text can be put into alternative displays.

Why Plain Text?

Plain text writing separates the domains of content and presentation (also sometimes referred to as views or displays) in digital environments. For what reasons might this be useful?

Examples of Plain Text Markup Languages

- ▶ HTML
- ▶ XML
- ▶ Tex (LaTeX)
- ▶ Markdown

Key Affordances

- ▶ Separating content from presentation
- ▶ Modularity
- ▶ Reuse
- ▶ Stability and preservation
- ▶ Accessibility
- ▶ Intentionality